



(12) **United States Plant Patent**
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(54) **PHLOX PLANT NAMED ‘BALKAPOPUR’**

(50) Latin Name: *Phlox paniculata*
Varietal Denomination: **Balkapopur**

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(52) **U.S. Cl.**
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See application file for complete search history.

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(57) **ABSTRACT**
A new and distinct cultivar of *Phlox* plant named ‘Balka-
popur’, characterized by its medium purple-colored flowers,
medium green-colored foliage, and moderately vigorous,
compact-upright growth habit, is disclosed.

1 Drawing Sheet

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Latin name of genus and species of plant claimed: *Phlox
paniculata*.
Variety denomination: ‘Balkapopur’.

BACKGROUND OF THE INVENTION

The present invention relates to a new and distinct cultivar
of *Phlox* plant botanically known as *Phlox paniculata* and
hereinafter referred to by the cultivar name ‘Balkapopur’.

The new cultivar originated in a controlled breeding
program in Hem, the Netherlands during August 2013. The
objective of the breeding program was the development of
Phlox cultivars with attractive flower coloration, increased
powdery mildew resistance and a compact growth habit.

The new *Phlox* cultivar is the result of open-pollination
within an insect-cage environment. The female (seed) parent
of the new cultivar is the proprietary *Phlox paniculata*
breeding selection coded D05, not patented, characterized
by its medium purple-colored flowers, medium green-col-
ored foliage, and moderately vigorous, compact-upright
growth habit. The male (pollen) parent of the new cultivar is
one of four proprietary *Phlox paniculata* breeding selec-
tions, not coded, not patented, characterized by having
different shades of purple-colored flowers, medium green-
colored foliage, and moderately vigorous, highly-branched,
upright growth habit. The new cultivar was discovered and
selected as a single flowering plant within the progeny of the
above stated open-pollination during July 2014 in a con-
trolled environment in Hem, the Netherlands.

Asexual reproduction of the new cultivar by terminal stem
cuttings since July 2014 in Hem, the Netherlands and
Elburn, Ill. has demonstrated that the new cultivar repro-
duces true to type with all of the characteristics, as herein
described, firmly fixed and retained through successive
generations of such asexual propagation.

SUMMARY OF THE INVENTION

The following characteristics of the new cultivar have
been repeatedly observed and can be used to distinguish
‘Balkapopur’ as a new and distinct cultivar of *Phlox* plant:

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1. Medium purple-colored flowers;
2. Medium green-colored foliage; and
3. Moderately vigorous, compact-upright growth habit.

Plants of the new cultivar differ from plants of the female
parent primarily in having a different shade of flower color
and increased branching. Plants of the new cultivar differ
from plants of the potential male parents primarily in having
a different shade of flower color.

Of the many commercially available *Phlox* cultivars, the
most similar in comparison to the new cultivar is Flame
Purple ‘Barfourteen’, U.S. Plant Pat. No. 12,605. However,
in side by side comparisons, plants of the new cultivar differ
from plants of ‘Barfourteen’ in at least the following char-
acteristics:

1. Plants of the new cultivar have a flower color that has
more purple than plants of ‘Barfourteen’;
2. Plants of the new cultivar are shorter than plants of
‘Barfourteen’; and
3. Plants of the new cultivar have larger diameter flowers
than plants of ‘Barfourteen’.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE PHOTOGRAPHS

The accompanying photographs show, as nearly true as it
is reasonably possible to make the same in color illustrations
of this type, typical flower and foliage characteristics of the
new cultivar. Colors in the photographs differ slightly from
the color values cited in the detailed description, which
accurately describes the colors of ‘Balkapopur’. The plants
were approximately four months old. The plants were grown
in one-gallon containers for approximately 11 weeks in a
greenhouse in Elburn, Ill. Plants were given two pinches,
one at one week before transplant and one two weeks after
transplant.

FIG. 1 illustrates a side view of the overall growth and
flowering habit of ‘Balkapopur’.

FIG. 2 illustrates a close-up view of an individual inflo-
rescence of ‘Balkapopur’.

DETAILED BOTANICAL DESCRIPTION

The new cultivar has not been observed under all possible
environmental conditions to date. Accordingly, it is possible

that the phenotype may vary somewhat with variations in the environment, such as temperature, light intensity, and day length, without, however, any variance in genotype.

The chart used in the identification of colors described herein is The R.H.S. Colour Chart of The Royal Horticultural Society, London, England, 2015 edition, except where general color terms of ordinary significance are used. The color values were determined in June 2018 under natural light conditions in West Chicago, Ill.

The following descriptions and measurements describe approximately four-month old plants produced from cuttings from stock plants and grown under conditions comparable to those used in commercial practice. The plants were grown in one-gallon containers for approximately 11 weeks in a greenhouse in Elburn, Ill. Plants were given two pinches, one at one week before transplant and one two weeks after transplant. Greenhouse temperatures were maintained at approximately 65° F. to 70° F. (18.3° C. to 21.1° C.) during the day and approximately 55° F. to 60° F. (12.8° C. to 15.6° C.) during the night. No supplemental lighting was provided. Measurements and numerical values represent averages of typical plants.

Botanical classification: *Phlox paniculata* 'Balkapopur'.

Parentage:

Female parent.—Proprietary *Phlox paniculata* breeding selection coded D05, not patented.

Male parent.—One of four proprietary *Phlox paniculata* breeding selections, not coded, not patented.

Propagation:

Type cutting.—Terminal stem.

Time to initiate roots.—Approximately 10 to 12 days.

Time to produce a rooted cutting.—Approximately 42 to 49 days.

Root description.—Fine to medium thickness, medium density.

Rooting habit.—Freely branching, medium density.

Plant description:

Commercial crop time.—Approximately 10 to 12 weeks from a rooted cutting to finish in a 15 cm pot.

Growth habit and general appearance.—Herbaceous perennial, moderately vigorous, compact-upright growth habit.

Hardiness.—USDA Zone 4b (−25° F. to −25° F./−20° C. to −28.9° C.).

Size.—Height: Approximately 28.0 cm. Width: Approximately 34.0 cm.

Branching habit.—Freely branching, pinching will improve branching.

Branch.—Quantity: Approximately 3 basal branches. Shape: Round. Strength: Strong. Length to base of inflorescence: Approximately 14.0 cm. Diameter: Approximately 5.0 mm. Length of central internode: Approximately 1.0 cm. Texture: Glabrous. Color of young stems: 146C. Color of mature stems: 146C, becoming woody 199C with age.

Foliage description:

General description.—Quantity of leaves per main branch: Approximately 20. Fragrance: None detected. Form: Simple. Arrangement: Opposite.

Leaves.—Shape: Elliptic, slightly carinate. Margin: Entire, minutely ciliate. Apex: Acute. Base: Attenuate. Venation pattern: Pinnate. Length: Approximately 8.5 cm. Width: Approximately 3.2 cm. Texture of upper surface: Sparsely pubescent. Texture of lower surface: Glabrous. Color of upper surface of

young and mature foliage: 137A with venation of 145C. Color of lower surface of young and mature foliage: Closest to 191A with venation of 145D.

Petioles.—Length: Approximately 2.0 mm. Width: Approximately 3.0 mm. Texture: Moderately pubescent. Color: 145D.

Flowering description:

Flowering habit.—'Balkapopur' is freely flowering under outdoor growing conditions with substantially continuous blooming from late spring throughout summer.

Lastingness of individual flower on the plant.—Approximately 10 days.

Inflorescence description:

General description.—Type: Compound terminal panicle, flowers face upright and outwardly, self-cleaning. Quantity per plant: Approximately 3. Fragrance: Moderately sweet and pleasant. Height of primary: Approximately 10.0 cm. Width of primary: Approximately 13.0 cm. Quantity of fully open flowers per primary inflorescence: Approximately 50. Height of secondary: Approximately 5.5 cm. Width of secondary: 7.5 cm. Quantity of fully open flowers per secondary inflorescence: Approximately 12.

Peduncle.—Strength: Strong. Aspect: Primary erect, axillary acute angle to stem. Length of primary: Approximately 3.5 cm. Diameter of primary: Approximately 5.0 mm. Length of axillary: Approximately 3.0 cm to 6.0 cm. Diameter of axillary: Approximately 2.0 mm. Texture: Densely pubescent. Color: 146C.

Flower description:

Type.—Single.

Bud.—Rate of opening: Generally takes 3 to 4 days for bud to progress from first color to fully open flower.

Bud just before opening.—Shape: Oblanceolate. Length: Approximately 1.9 cm. Diameter: Approximately 4.0 mm. Color: 145C with petal portion of NN155D mottled with N88B.

Corolla.—Shape: Salverform. Diameter: Approximately 2.7 cm. Depth: Approximately 2.5 cm.

Petals.—Quantity: 5 in a single whorl, base fused into a narrow tube. Lobe shape: Obovate. Margin: Entire. Apex: Obtuse. Lobe length: Approximately 1.2 cm. Lobe width: Approximately 1.5 cm. Texture of upper and lower surfaces: Smooth, glabrous. Color of upper surface when first open: NN78B heavily tinted with N81B. Color of lower surface when first open: NN155D mottled with N82B. Color of upper surface when fully open: NN78C tinted with N81B to N81C. Color of lower surface when fully open: NN155D mottled with N82B.

Corolla tube.—Length: Approximately 2.1 cm. Diameter at distal end: Approximately 3.0 mm. Diameter at proximal end: Approximately 2.0 mm. Texture of outer surface: Moderately pubescent. Texture of inner surface: Smooth, glabrous with lower 6.0 mm densely pubescent. Color of inner surface: N82A at throat opening transitioning through NN155D to 145D at base. Color of outer surface: NN155D mottled with N82B, 145D at base.

Calyx.—Shape: Cupped. Length: Approximately 9.0 mm. Diameter: Approximately 3.0 mm.

Sepals.—Quantity per flower: 5, lower half fused. Shape: Lanceolate. Apex: Narrowly apiculate. Length: Approximately 9.0 mm. Width: Approximately 2.0 mm. Texture of outer surface: Sparsely pubescent. Texture of inner surface: Smooth, gla- 5 brous. Color of inner surface: 146C with tip of N186A. Color of outer surface: 146D with tip of and central streak of N186A.

*Pedice*l.—Strength: Strong, flexible. Aspect: Primary erect, axillary acute angle to peduncle. Length: 10 Approximately 4.0 mm. Diameter: Approximately 1.0 mm. Texture: Densely pubescent. Color: 146C typically tinted with 187A.

Reproductive organs.—Androecium: Stamen quantity: 5 per flower, adnate to corolla tube. Stamen length: 15 Approximately 2.0 cm. Filament length of free portion: Approximately 1.0 mm. Anther shape: Sagit-

tate. Anther length: Approximately 2.0 mm. Anther color: 158B. Pollen amount: Abundant. Pollen color: 155D. Gynoecium: Pistil quantity: 1 per flower. Pistil length: Approximately 1.7 cm. Stigma shape: Cleft, three-parted. Stigma color: 145D. Style length: Approximately 1.5 cm. Style color: 145D. Ovary length: Approximately 2.0 mm. Ovary color: 144A.

Seed and fruit production: Neither seed nor fruit production has been observed.

Disease and pest resistance: Increased resistance to powdery mildew has been observed.

What is claimed is:

1. A new and distinct cultivar of *Phlox* plant named 'Balkapopur', substantially as herein illustrated and described.

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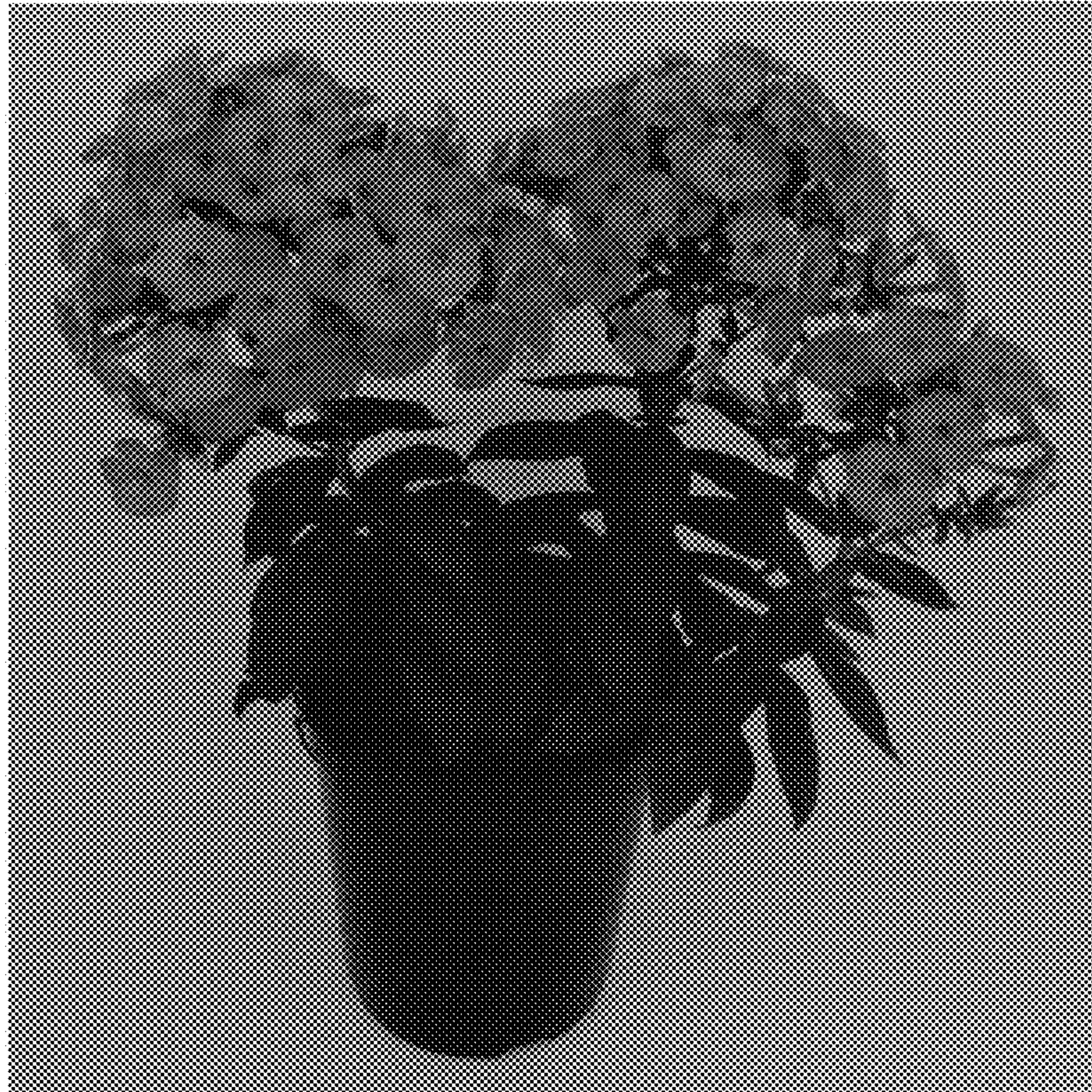


FIG. 1



FIG. 2